

corporations into “conservatorship,” ⁵ and putting taxpayers on the hook for hundreds of billions of dollars.

The dramatic increase in mortgage accessibility and increasing consumer spending caused American household debt to nearly double between 2000 and 2007, eventually reaching a record \$13.8 *trillion*.⁶

If the 2008 “Great Recession” had a silver lining, it was that the high rate of foreclosures and the fear of job loss led many Americans to dramatically increase their saving⁷ and reduce consumer debt⁸ as the first decade of the new millennium drew to a close.